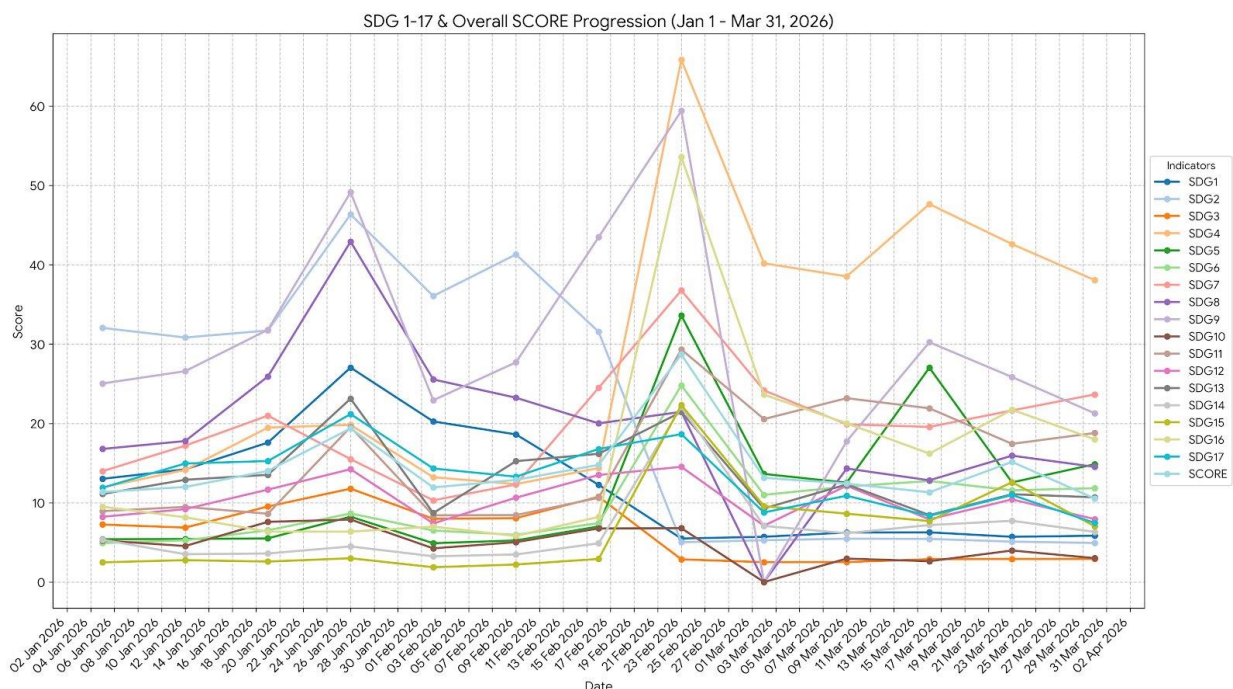


SCORE INDEX INSIGHTS (JANUARY–MARCH 2026)

The SCORE Index captures the extent to which the business media is expending efforts, through their publications, to disseminate sustainability-related content and raise social and environmental awareness among citizens. Some of the key highlights during the January–March 2026 quarter are given below:

Between January and March 2026, business dailies continued to engage with sustainability-related themes, with notable intensity around climate policy, economic development, and green-technology innovation. The pattern of coverage revealed that SDG 4 (Quality Education) and SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth) emerged as dominant themes, registering exceptionally high scores — particularly in late February, where SDG 4 peaked sharply at over 65 and SDG 8 approached 60. Coverage of these SDGs was most prominently discussed when linked to business opportunity, workforce development, and institutional investment narratives.



During this period, several globally relevant climate- and sustainability-linked developments took place, including key international policy forums, continued expansion of climate-finance mechanisms, and heightened regulatory discourse on green industrial policy. In the Indian context, business coverage strongly reflected themes such as quality education investments, green energy transition, and ESG governance frameworks. These were most closely associated with SDG 2 (Zero Hunger), SDG 4 (Quality Education), SDG 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy), SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), and SDG 9 (Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure) — which consistently recorded higher-than-average index scores across the quarter.

In contrast, biodiversity- and nature-related SDGs — particularly SDG 14 (Life Below Water) and SDG 15 (Life on Land) — remained among the lowest-scoring themes throughout the quarter. SDG 1 (No Poverty), SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities), and SDG 3 (Good Health and Well-being) also registered consistently low scores, indicating that equity, health, and ecological protection issues continue to receive comparatively limited business media attention relative to economic and technological sustainability themes.

A notable feature of this quarter was the moderate-to-elevated attention to SDG 13 (Climate Action), which showed persistent coverage across January and February, before tapering in March. Peaks in SDG 13 coverage aligned with days when climate investment announcements, carbon policy discussions, or climate-risk reporting appeared prominently in business pages. However, this attention tended to cluster around macro-economic and financial narratives rather than broader climate-justice or adaptation discussions.

Interestingly, inequality-centred SDGs — such as SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities) — also remained relatively low in comparison to growth-oriented SDGs throughout the quarter. This pattern suggests that structural equity debates continue to receive less sustained editorial attention than economic and technological sustainability themes. SDG 5 (Gender Equality) showed occasional spikes but did not sustain elevated coverage across the full quarter.

At the same time, the quarter highlighted ongoing institutionalisation of sustainability within business discourse. Coverage of corporate ESG reporting, sustainability-linked investment, climate-transition planning, and regulatory developments

contributed to consistently elevated scores for SDG 9 and SDG 17 (Partnerships for the Goals). This indicates that sustainability is now embedded within the language of commerce, policy, and investment, rather than appearing merely as a social-sector concern.

	News Seen	News Not Seen
News Expected	Sharp spikes in overall SCORE (peaking at 65.21 on 27 Feb 2026) driven by strong increases in SDG 4 (Quality Education), SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), and SDG 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy), reflecting heightened coverage around global climate finance negotiations, education investment summits, and green industrial policy discussions.	Despite dates associated with World Water Day and International Day of Forests in March, no corresponding or sustained spikes were observed in SDG 6 (Clean Water and Sanitation) or SDG 15 (Life on Land), suggesting limited alignment of coverage with expected environmental observances.
News Not Expected	Unexpected spikes in SDG 5 (Gender Equality) and SDG 13 (Climate Action) on 27 Feb and 1 Mar 2026, with a very high overall SCORE (59.89) — driven by critical reporting on gender equity in climate finance, institutional governance, and social justice issues rather than scheduled sustainability events.	SDG 3 (Good Health and Well-being) and SDG 1 (No Poverty) remained persistently low throughout the quarter, with SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities) also failing to register coverage spikes, despite ongoing urban development and public health policy discussions in business media.